09-12 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Letter That Took Ten Years to Arrive

① On a slow Sunday afternoon in September, my mother asked me to help her tidy the **old wooden wardrobe** in the spare room. It was something she had been talking about for two years but never actually started. We pulled out soft cotton jumpers that no one wore any more, a box of old family photos, and three shopping bags full of letters and cards. Near the back of the wardrobe, pressed against the wooden wall, I found a **small pale-yellow envelope** that had fallen behind a drawer. My mother's name was handwritten across the front in blue ink. "**To be opened in the autumn of 2027.**"

② My mother stared at the envelope for a long second, as if she did not recognise her own name. Then her face changed, very slowly. "Oh," she said softly. "That was Aunt Xiuhua's letter." She sat down on the edge of the spare bed, holding the yellow envelope in her hands, neither opening it nor putting it down.

③ Aunt Xiuhua, I knew, was not a real aunt. She had been my mother's best friend since primary school. In their twenties, the two of them had shared a small flat in a northern city, walking to work together every morning. Then Aunt Xiuhua moved to Xinjiang to follow a job and later to start a small clothing shop there. For many years, she and my mother wrote letters, then emails, then fewer and fewer messages. Ten years ago, Aunt Xiuhua passed away suddenly from a bad illness. My mother cried for a whole week, and then, as people do, slowly returned to ordinary life.

④ "She wrote this letter three months before she was gone," my mother said finally. "She asked me not to open it for ten years — she said, 'You will need it more **then** than now.' I put it in this wardrobe, and then life just..." Her voice trailed away. She looked at the date on her phone. "It is autumn 2027," she whispered. "I really did forget."

⑤ I sat down next to her on the bed. I did not say anything. After a few minutes, my mother carefully opened the envelope with her thumb, the way careful people open ancient letters in films. Inside there was one A4 sheet of paper, folded twice, and one very small black-and-white photograph — the two of them, at about twenty, laughing on a wooden bench outside a dumpling shop.

⑥ The letter was written in Aunt Xiuhua's round, friendly handwriting. I will not copy all of it here, because it belongs to my mother. But my mother read a few lines out loud, in a quiet, shaking voice. "Dear Lili, in ten years you will be somewhere in your forties. If I guess you right, you will be working too much, worrying too much, sleeping too little. You will be proud of your child, but also too quick to criticise her. You will have started

forgetting to laugh at small things. Please do three things for me when you open this letter..."

⑦ The three things were: take a Thursday off work, cook a plate of dumplings with your daughter, and call one old school friend you have not talked to for a year. "Do not cry too long," Aunt Xiuhua had written. "Just do the three small things. That is enough. That is everything."

⑧ My mother set the letter down, wiped her eyes with the back of her hand, and looked at me as if she had found me for the first time that day. "Next Thursday," she said, in a slightly stronger voice, "I will take the afternoon off. I will come home early. You and I will make dumplings. We will try the fold Aunt Xiuhua always did — with three small pleats. Later I will call Aunt Jiang, who I have not spoken to since spring." She paused, and smiled, still with wet eyes. "Aunt Xiuhua knew me better than I knew myself."

⑨ Next Thursday, we made dumplings. They were ugly. We laughed anyway. My mother called Aunt Jiang in the evening and talked for a long time, and I heard her laugh through the wall twice, in a way I had almost forgotten. Aunt Xiuhua's letter now sits on the top shelf of my mother's bedside, and the small black-and-white photo stands beside it in a simple frame. Some letters, I have learned, **take ten years to arrive on purpose** — because the person who sent them knew exactly the day we would need them most.

注释： wardrobe 衣柜；envelope 信封；criticise 批评；pleat 折褶；for a long second 好一会儿

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Where did the writer find the small pale-yellow envelope?

A. In a drawer of her school desk.
B. In her mother's handbag.
C. Behind a drawer at the back of an old wooden wardrobe in the spare room.
D. At the post office.

2. Who was Aunt Xiuhua to the writer's mother?

A. The writer's biological aunt on the father's side.
B. A real blood sister.
C. The mother's best friend since primary school, who later lived in Xinjiang.
D. Just a neighbour the mother hardly knew.

3. When and why did Aunt Xiuhua write the letter, according to the mother?

A. At primary school, for her teacher to read.
B. Three months before she passed away, asking the mother not to open it for ten years

— she would "need it more then than now".
C. On the day she moved to Xinjiang, saying goodbye.
D. She did not actually write the letter herself.

4. Which of the following is one of the three things Aunt Xiuhua asked the mother to do?

A. Buy a new car immediately.
B. Cook a plate of dumplings with her daughter.
C. Sell the old family home.
D. Learn a new foreign language.

5. What does the writer mean by the final sentence, "Some letters take ten years to arrive on purpose"?

A. The postman was very lazy.
B. The letter was written on a very slow sort of paper.
C. The writer of the letter chose the exact later moment when her friend would need it most, as a quiet, thoughtful gift of time.
D. Aunt Xiuhua had forgotten to post the letter properly.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 "Near the back of the wardrobe, pressed against the wooden wall, I found a small pale-yellow envelope that had fallen behind a drawer"
【解析】信藏在旧衣柜抽屉后面。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "She had been my mother's best friend since primary school"
【解析】秀华阿姨是母亲小学起的挚友，后来移居新疆。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "She wrote this letter three months before she was gone ... 'You will need it more then than now.'"
【解析】临终前约三月写下并嘱咐十年后拆阅。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B

【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段 "take a Thursday off work, cook a plate of dumplings with your daughter, and call one old school friend"
【解析】"与女儿一起做饺子"为三件事之一。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】句意理解/主旨题
【定位】第⑨段末句
【解析】作者感悟在于信件正准时抵达——寄信人深知何时最需要它。A、B、D 均为字面误读。故选 C。